

Document	OPS-02 Vehicle & Driver Safety Standard
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Owner	Fleet Safety Manager
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Vehicle & Driver Safety Standard

1. Purpose and scope

Our vehicles share the road with the public every hour of the day. This standard sets out what we expect from every driver and every manager so that vehicles are roadworthy, drivers are rested and fit, and nobody takes risks to hit a delivery time. No delivery is ever so urgent that it justifies breaking these rules.

1.1 Who this applies to

This standard applies to everyone who drives a Tallowby Freight vehicle, including HGVs, vans and yard shunters, and to agency drivers working for us. Sections 3 and 6 also apply to the Transport Planning Office, because planners must not issue work that would force a driver to break the rules.

1.2 Responsibilities

- **Drivers** are responsible for checking their vehicle, keeping to the hours rules and reporting defects and incidents.
- **Transport planners** are responsible for planning routes and loads that can be completed legally, including traffic and loading time.
- **Depot managers** make sure checks are done and defects are repaired before a vehicle goes back out.
- **The Fleet Safety Manager** owns this standard, reviews tachograph data and licence checks and leads investigations into road incidents.

2. Daily vehicle checks

2.1 Walkaround check before each shift

Before you drive any vehicle for the first time in a shift, carry out a full walkaround check. Allow at least 15 minutes for an HGV and 10 minutes for a van; this time is paid and is built into your start time. Check lights, tyres, wheel nuts, mirrors, brakes, fluid levels, the load and its security, and the coupling if you are pulling a trailer. Record the check on the vehicle check app on your handheld. If you take over a vehicle from another driver during the day, do a fresh check.

2.2 Defects that stop the vehicle

If you find a defect that makes the vehicle unsafe or illegal, such as a damaged tyre, a brake warning light, a broken mirror or a load that cannot be secured, do not drive it. Record the defect on the app, tell the Transport Planning Office on ext. 100 straight away and hand the keys to the workshop.

Minor defects that do not affect safety can be recorded and the vehicle used, but the workshop must be told before the end of your shift.

2.3 When the handheld is not working

If the app or handheld is not working, complete the paper defect sheet, form OPS-DC1, which is kept in every cab. Hand it to the depot office at the end of your shift. A check that is not recorded is treated as a check that was not done.

3. Drivers' hours and rest

Our HGV drivers work under the UK drivers' hours rules and the road transport working time rules. The limits below summarise the main points. If there is any doubt, the stricter rule applies. Van drivers follow the company limits in 3.1 and 3.2 even where the law does not require it.

3.1 Daily driving

You may drive for no more than 9 hours in a day. Twice a week this can be extended to 10 hours. Transport planners will not routinely plan more than 8.5 hours of driving, so that there is time for traffic and delays.

3.2 Breaks

After 4.5 hours of driving you must take a break of at least 45 minutes. The break can be split into a first part of at least 15 minutes and a second part of at least 30 minutes, taken in that order. Time spent loading or waiting at a customer's site does not count as a break unless you are genuinely free to rest.

3.3 Weekly and fortnightly limits

You may drive for no more than 56 hours in a week and no more than 90 hours in any two consecutive weeks. Your total working time, including loading, paperwork and other work, must not go over 60 hours in any single week or an average of 48 hours a week.

3.4 Daily and weekly rest

You need a daily rest of at least 11 hours. It can be reduced to 9 hours no more than 3 times between two weekly rests. The normal weekly rest is 45 hours in a row. A reduced weekly rest of at least 24 hours is allowed in some weeks, but the reduction must be made up later, as the planners will show on your rota.

3.5 Tachographs

Always use your own driver card and never lend it to anyone. Make manual entries for any work done away from the vehicle. Your card is downloaded at the depot at least every 7 days, more often than the law requires, so that problems can be spotted early. If your card is lost, stolen or not working, tell the Transport Planning Office before you drive and follow their instructions on printouts.

4. Mobile phones and distractions

4.1 Mobile phones

You must not hold or use a phone or handheld in any way while the engine is running. This includes when you are stopped at traffic lights or queuing in traffic. The only calls allowed while driving are hands-free calls through the cab system from the Transport Planning Office. Keep them short and

pull over safely if the conversation needs more than a minute. Using a handheld phone while driving is treated as gross misconduct.

4.2 Sat-nav and in-cab devices

Set your route before you move off. If you need to change it, stop somewhere safe first. The in-cab camera records the road ahead and the driver's view. Footage is only reviewed after an incident, a complaint or a customer claim, and never for routine monitoring.

5. Alcohol, drugs and medication

5.1 Company rule

The company rule is stricter than the legal drink-drive limit. You must not start a shift with any detectable alcohol in your body, and you must not drink alcohol in the 10 hours before the start of a driving shift. Illegal drugs are not allowed at any time. Breaking this rule is gross misconduct.

5.2 Random testing

We carry out unannounced breath and saliva tests on drivers, using an independent testing provider. At least 10% of our drivers are selected at random each year. You will be tested in private and the result is shared only with you, the Fleet Safety Manager and HR. Refusing a test, or leaving before it is finished, is treated in the same way as a positive result.

5.3 Medication

Some prescription and over-the-counter medicines can make you drowsy. If a medicine's label or your pharmacist says it may affect your driving, tell your line manager or the Fleet Safety Manager before your next shift. You do not have to say what the condition is. You will be given other work where possible while you take it.

5.4 Testing after an incident

Any driver involved in a collision in a company vehicle, or in an incident where someone is injured, will be asked to take a drug and alcohol test. The test should be done as soon as practical, and within 4 hours of the incident unless the driver needs medical treatment first.

6. Fines, penalties and licences

6.1 Parking penalties during deliveries

Our work sometimes means stopping where legal parking is not available. If you receive a parking penalty while following your delivery instructions and there was no legal alternative, the company will pay it. To qualify, report the penalty to the Transport Planning Office within 48 hours on form OPS-F1, giving the delivery reference. Penalties for parking to take a personal break, or for parking that put other road users at risk, are the driver's responsibility.

6.2 Speeding and other driving offences

Speeding, red light, mobile phone and similar offences are the driver's personal responsibility, and the company will not pay the fine. When we receive a notice for one of our vehicles, the Fleet Safety Manager will name the driver to the police or issuing authority within the legal deadline. You must help us identify who was driving.

6.3 Road user charges

Congestion charges, clean air zone charges, river crossings and road tolls on company routes are paid by the company through its accounts. Do not pay them yourself unless the Transport Planning Office asks you to, in which case claim them back under FIN-03.

6.4 Licence checks and penalty points

We check every driver's licence electronically every 6 months, and every 3 months for drivers with 6 or more penalty points. You must tell the Fleet Safety Manager within 7 days if you receive penalty points, a driving ban, a court summons for a driving offence or a medical condition that you are required to report to the licensing authority.

7. Breakdowns and collisions

7.1 Breakdowns

If your vehicle breaks down, get it off the carriageway if you can, switch on the hazard lights and phone the Transport Planning Office on ext. 100. They will arrange recovery. On a motorway, leave the cab by the nearside door and wait behind the barrier, well away from the vehicle.

7.2 Collisions

If you are involved in any collision in a company vehicle, however minor, follow the steps at the scene in HSE-04 Incident & Accident Reporting Procedure, section 5. The Fleet Safety Manager investigates every collision involving a company vehicle.